

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Banking Operations English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For bank operations staff, branch managers, loan operations teams, KYC/AML analysts, fraud operations staff, payment operations teams, compliance staff, and banking leaders.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 Account-opening discrepancy

02 Monitoring alert review

03 Loan documentation gap

04 Payment exception

05 A fraud-related customer call

06 Control reconciliation

07 Exam evidence request

08 Fair complaint handling

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Account-opening discrepancy

Bank staff reconcile identity information.

Roles: Account-opening analyst / Branch manager

Account-opening analyst: The application address differs from the identity document. The required verification is incomplete.

Branch manager: Follow our customer-identification process and ask for the appropriate clarification or documentation.

Account-opening analyst: The customer wants the account opened immediately because they're traveling.

Branch manager: Explain the outstanding requirement clearly. Don't bypass it or promise approval before review.

Account-opening analyst: I'll record the discrepancy and the requested next step through the approved system.

Branch manager: I'll support the escalation if the circumstances require specialist review under the bank's process.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The application address differs from the identity document. The required verification is incomplete." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Monitoring alert review

Analysts discuss an unusual activity alert.

Roles: AML analyst / Review supervisor

AML analyst: The alert shows activity outside the account's expected pattern, but that doesn't establish wrongdoing.

Review supervisor: Review the relevant customer information and transaction context under our monitoring procedures.

AML analyst: I'll document what is known, what differs, and what evidence is missing.

Review supervisor: Keep speculation separate from the factual analysis and use the designated escalation channel.

AML analyst: I'll submit the case for the required review without discussing internal reporting decisions externally.

Review supervisor: I'll assess the documented work and confirm the appropriate next steps under our process.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The alert shows activity outside the account's expected pattern, but that doesn't establish wrongdoing." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Loan documentation gap

Loan operations checks a file before processing.

Roles: Loan operations specialist / Credit officer

Loan operations specialist: The approval record is present, but a required signed document is missing from the file.

Credit officer: Check whether the current approval includes any conditions that remain outstanding.

Loan operations specialist: It does. Should I treat the approval itself as permission to proceed?

Credit officer: No. Confirm the conditions through the authorized process before taking the next operational step.

Loan operations specialist: I'll list the missing item and route the request to the responsible team.

Credit officer: I'll clarify the approval conditions and document any further authorized decision.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "It does. Should I treat the approval itself as permission to proceed?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Payment exception

Operations investigates a payment with inconsistent details.

Roles: Payments analyst / Operations supervisor

Payments analyst: The beneficiary name and the supporting instruction don't match. The payment is in the exception queue.

Operations supervisor: Preserve the instruction and follow the approved verification route before making any change.

Payments analyst: The requester sent a new bank detail by email and says it's urgent.

Operations supervisor: Urgency doesn't verify the change. Use the bank's independent confirmation process.

Payments analyst: I'll record the discrepancy and the steps taken without exposing account details in the team chat.

Operations supervisor: I'll review the exception and ensure the authorized outcome is recorded before processing continues.

Notice the professional language

exception queue - A list of items requiring review because normal processing could not complete them.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

A fraud-related customer call

A branch employee consults the fraud team.

Roles: Branch adviser / Fraud operations specialist

Branch adviser: A customer reports a transfer they say they didn't authorize. What should I record?

Fraud operations specialist: The reported facts, transaction reference, and contact details through the approved intake process.

Branch adviser: They're asking whether we can guarantee recovery.

Fraud operations specialist: Don't guarantee an outcome. Explain the immediate reporting and review steps accurately and follow the escalation procedure.

Branch adviser: I'll connect the customer through the designated channel and document the handoff.

Fraud operations specialist: I'll confirm receipt and coordinate the case under our fraud-response process.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "A customer reports a transfer they say they didn't authorize. What should I record?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Control reconciliation

An operations team finds an unexplained difference.

Roles: Reconciliation analyst / Control manager

Reconciliation analyst: The settlement total differs from the ledger by \$8,500. I haven't identified the cause.

Control manager: Keep the exception visible. Which batches and timestamps have you compared?

Reconciliation analyst: Today's batches. One posting may have crossed the reporting cutoff, but that remains a hypothesis.

Control manager: Check the source references and subsequent postings before proposing an adjustment.

Reconciliation analyst: I'll document the investigation and retain the original reconciliation.

Control manager: Route any adjustment through the approval process with the supporting evidence and reason clearly stated.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Keep the exception visible. Which batches and timestamps have you compared?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Exam evidence request

Bank staff prepare materials for a regulatory examination.

Roles: Exam coordinator / Control owner

Exam coordinator: The request asks for evidence of control operation during the quarter, not just the current procedure.

Control owner: I'll provide dated review records, exceptions, approvals, and follow-up evidence through the approved channel.

Exam coordinator: Flag missing records rather than recreating them as if they existed at the time.

Control owner: Understood. I'll distinguish verified evidence from unresolved gaps.

Exam coordinator: I'll track the request, responsible owner, and response status.

Control owner: I'll review the package for accuracy and permitted disclosure before submission.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The request asks for evidence of control operation during the quarter, not just the current procedure." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Fair complaint handling

A team reviews a service complaint involving fees.

Roles: Complaints specialist / Branch manager

Complaints specialist: The customer says the fee was never explained. What records show the disclosure and the actual charge?

Branch manager: I'll retrieve the account terms, relevant communication, and transaction history.

Complaints specialist: We should consider their specific concern rather than assume the standard letter answers it.

Branch manager: Agreed. I'll also check whether staff provided inconsistent information.

Complaints specialist: I'll explain the review process and current status without promising an unapproved refund.

Branch manager: We'll document the findings and any authorized remedy through the complaint process.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The customer says the fee was never explained. What records show the disclosure and the actual charge?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: name one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Account Opening and KYC

SHARED CASE

An account application lacks requested ownership information. The applicant asks staff to open the account before the review is complete.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ...

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you provide the outstanding ownership information through the approved channel? I can explain what is missing, but the application still needs to follow the bank's review process.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

AML Monitoring and Suspicious Activity

SHARED CASE

A monitoring alert identifies unusual transactions. The analyst has not determined their explanation. The internal note must remain neutral.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The transactions differ from the expected pattern and require review. That is an observation, not a conclusion about intent. I'll document the relevant facts through the approved confidential process.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Loan Operations and Documentation

SHARED CASE

A loan operations checklist marks a condition complete, but the supporting document refers to a different version of the agreement.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Which agreement version governs this condition? Let's confirm the reference and required evidence before recording the item as complete in the operations checklist.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Payment Operations and Exceptions

SHARED CASE

A payments queue has 45 exceptions, with 30 reviewed and 15 pending. A manager asks whether all items have been resolved.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

Thirty exceptions have been reviewed, but review does not necessarily mean resolution. Fifteen are still pending review. I'll report the disposition status separately so the update is accurate.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Fraud Operations and Customer Escalation

SHARED CASE

A customer reporting a disputed transaction receives conflicting explanations of the process. The case outcome has not been determined.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Useful expressions

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'm sorry the explanations differed. Let me confirm the applicable process and your case status with the responsible team. I'll distinguish the next procedural step from any outcome that is still undecided.

Second round

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Operational Risk and Controls

SHARED CASE

A reconciliation is signed off even though one unmatched balance remains under investigation.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

The reconciliation work has been performed, but the unmatched balance remains open. I'll show that exception and its review status instead of implying that every item has been resolved.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Audit and Regulatory Exams

SHARED CASE

An examination request asks for evidence of a control operating over a stated period. The team has only the policy document ready.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you identify the records that demonstrate the control's operation during the requested period? The policy describes the process, but we also need the relevant evidence of its use.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Customer Complaints and Fair Treatment

SHARED CASE

A customer asks why a fee was charged. The representative has a current fee schedule but has not checked the transaction details.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Useful expressions

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Cover this until after your first attempt

I can explain the published fee schedule, and I'll ask the responsible team to review how it applies to this transaction. I do not want to give you an unverified explanation of the charge.

Second round

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Say one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Ownership information is still required for review

Fictional account-opening exercise: this application's existing request asks for Mira Chen's ownership percentage, which is missing. The application review is incomplete. This case-specific request is not a universal banking requirement; actual decisions follow current authorized procedures.

01 • Account-opening specialist: Could you provide the requested ownership information through our approved channel so the application review can continue?

02 • Company finance officer: Can you open the account first? Our team needs it before the review is finished.

03 • Account-opening specialist: I can't treat the incomplete review as approved. I'll explain the outstanding request clearly.

04 • Company finance officer: Which information is missing? I don't want to resend unrelated documents or guess your requirements.

05 • Account-opening specialist: Please provide Mira Chen's ownership percentage, as requested for this application. When can you supply it?

06 • Company finance officer: Does beneficial owner simply mean the person who signed the application for the company?

07 • Account-opening specialist: Don't assume they're identical. The applicable definition and requested details need the authorized KYC review.

08 • Company finance officer: I'll ask our authorized company contact to provide the specified information and confirm availability.

09 • Account-opening specialist: Thank you. That supports know-your-customer review without promising approval or assigning a risk rating here.

10 • Company finance officer: I'll explain that providing the missing information advances review, but doesn't guarantee account opening.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Identity evidence does not settle ownership

Separate fictional onboarding case: an applicant's identity document is received, while requested company ownership information remains outstanding.

01 • Relationship coordinator: We received the signer's identity document. Can we mark all account-opening checks complete?

02 • Onboarding reviewer: No. The requested ownership information is still outstanding, so the overall review remains open.

03 • Relationship coordinator: Could you identify the next request clearly so I don't ask the client for everything again?

04 • Onboarding reviewer: Please ask for the outstanding ownership information specified in the current application request.

05 • Relationship coordinator: Does completing an identity check under the customer identification program, CIP, establish beneficial ownership too?

06 • Onboarding reviewer: We shouldn't equate those checks. Follow the applicable review requirements for each outstanding item.

07 • Relationship coordinator: I'll keep the received identity document separate from the missing company information in our status update.

08 • Onboarding reviewer: Good. Use the approved channel and avoid circulating identification material in general internal messages.

09 • Relationship coordinator: I'll request an achievable delivery point from the client rather than promise account activation today.

10 • Onboarding reviewer: That gives a clear action and purpose without bypassing review or overstating what one document establishes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A changed ownership chart needs a verified version

Separate fictional application case: two company ownership charts differ; neither is identified as current, and no onboarding decision is available.

01 • Onboarding analyst: Could you confirm which ownership chart is current? The two submitted versions show different information.

02 • Corporate relationship manager: I can ask the authorized company contact. Should I simply use the one received most recently?

03 • Onboarding analyst: Receipt order alone doesn't establish current ownership. We need a verified explanation of the difference.

04 • Corporate relationship manager: I'll request the current chart and the relevant clarification through the approved document channel.

05 • Onboarding analyst: Please identify both versions so the client can address the actual discrepancy instead of resending blindly.

06 • Corporate relationship manager: Does the mismatch mean we should assign the highest risk rating before the review?

07 • Onboarding analyst: That determination belongs to the authorized process. Here we should describe the discrepancy factually.

08 • Corporate relationship manager: I'll avoid labeling it deception or promising acceptance after a corrected chart arrives.

09 • Onboarding analyst: Good. Ask when the verified information is available, keeping any formal requirements unchanged.

10 • Corporate relationship manager: I'll return the client's confirmed status and preserve the unresolved ownership question until reviewed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Account Opening and KYC

An account application lacks requested ownership information. The applicant asks staff to open the account before the review is complete.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you provide the outstanding ownership information through the approved channel? I can explain what is missing, but the application still needs to follow the bank's review process.

Scenario 2 | A translated document needs the specified review

A fictional business applicant supplies a document in a language the onboarding reviewer cannot assess. The current process's translation requirements have not been checked. Request an authorized clarification rather than inventing a requirement or approving the application.

Role A: Onboarding coordinator: ask the review lead to confirm the applicable translation requirements.

Role B: Relationship manager: explain the applicant needs a specific request and realistic timing.

Possible opening: Could you confirm the applicable translation requirements so we give the applicant an accurate document request?

Success checks

- Avoid interpreting unverified ownership information.
- Request the applicable requirement from the authorized source.
- Keep approval and timing unpromised.

Add a complication: Someone suggests guessing the ownership details from familiar names in the document.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An alert is not a finding of wrongdoing

Fictional internal anti-money-laundering review: a monitoring alert identifies unusual transactions, but their explanation is unknown. No detection thresholds or customer-contact tactics are discussed.

01 • AML analyst: The alert identifies unusual transactions, but the draft note says the customer is laundering money.

02 • Monitoring supervisor: That conclusion is unsupported. Record the observed activity and the context still needed for review.

03 • AML analyst: Can I call the pattern confirmed structuring because the monitoring system generated an alert?

04 • Monitoring supervisor: No. An alert isn't a finding of intent or an established explanation for the activity.

05 • AML analyst: I'll separate the system flag from our assessment and preserve the supporting records internally.

06 • Monitoring supervisor: Good. Any suspicious activity report, or SAR, decision follows the authorized process, not this initial label.

07 • AML analyst: Should I tell the relationship team to discuss the alert's details directly with the customer?

08 • Monitoring supervisor: Don't initiate disclosure outside the approved process. Escalate communication questions through authorized channels, including tipping-off concerns.

09 • AML analyst: I'll keep the note neutral and ask the reviewer which context is missing for the assessment.

10 • Monitoring supervisor: That supports a careful review without prejudging the customer or disclosing restricted internal monitoring information.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A familiar explanation is still unverified

Separate fictional internal review: a colleague suggests an unusual transfer pattern reflects seasonal business activity, but the case evidence has not established that explanation.

01 • Monitoring analyst: A colleague says these transfers probably reflect seasonal business activity. Can we close the alert?

02 • AML review lead: That is a possible explanation, not a verified finding in the evidence we currently have.

03 • Monitoring analyst: Then the neutral note should preserve the hypothesis without presenting it as confirmed context.

04 • AML review lead: Yes. Use the authorized review process to identify what evidence is relevant and available.

05 • Monitoring analyst: Would replacing the suspicion with a reassuring explanation be fairer to the customer?

06 • AML review lead: Fairness requires accurate evidence, not either an accusation or an unsupported reassuring conclusion.

07 • Monitoring analyst: I'll state that the explanation remains unverified and keep the observed activity separate.

08 • AML review lead: Good. Don't include operational monitoring details in broad messages or make independent disclosure decisions.

09 • Monitoring analyst: I'll route any communication and reporting questions to the authorized reviewer without assuming a SAR outcome.

10 • AML review lead: Exactly. The next step is a documented assessment, not closing or escalating solely on a colleague's guess.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An incomplete record limits the comparison

Separate fictional monitoring case: an analyst compares current transactions with an earlier period, but the earlier-period extract is incomplete.

01 • Financial crime analyst: The current activity looks higher than the earlier period, but the older extract is incomplete.

02 • Monitoring quality reviewer: Then we can't treat that comparison as a verified change across two equivalent periods.

03 • Financial crime analyst: Should the internal note say the increase may reflect missing historical records rather than customer behavior?

04 • Monitoring quality reviewer: State the data limitation without choosing a cause. Both the comparison and explanation need review.

05 • Financial crime analyst: I'll request the authorized complete extract and avoid treating missing transactions as zero activity.

06 • Monitoring quality reviewer: Good. Preserve the current alert evidence while identifying the specific gap in the historical comparison.

07 • Financial crime analyst: Does the data gap itself establish deliberate concealment or justify calling the activity structuring?

08 • Monitoring quality reviewer: No. It doesn't establish intent, and those labels shouldn't substitute for the authorized AML assessment.

09 • Financial crime analyst: I'll keep the case note restricted, neutral, and explicit about the incomplete comparison.

10 • Monitoring quality reviewer: That gives the next reviewer a sound starting point without an unsupported allegation or premature closure.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | AML Monitoring and Suspicious Activity

A monitoring alert identifies unusual transactions. The analyst has not determined their explanation. The internal note must remain neutral.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The transactions differ from the expected pattern and require review. That is an observation, not a conclusion about intent. I'll document the relevant facts through the approved confidential process.

Scenario 2 | A business description is out of date

A fictional internal monitoring file contains an old business description, and a current alert is being compared against it. No updated description or explanation is verified. Discuss the limitation and the authorized review needed.

Role A: AML analyst: identify the age of the context without assuming the transactions are improper.

Role B: Review supervisor: ask what verified information is missing and keep communication within approved channels.

Possible opening: The alert is being compared with an old business description, so the context may not reflect current activity.

Success checks

- Preserve uncertainty about current business context.
- Avoid accusations or unsupported closure.
- Refer disclosure and further-information decisions through the authorized process.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to tell the customer exactly which monitoring rule generated the alert.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which agreement version supports the completed condition?

Fictional loan-operations review: a condition is marked complete, but its supporting document references a different agreement version; no funding authorization is given.

01 • Loan operations analyst: The checklist marks this condition complete, but the supporting document refers to another agreement version.

02 • Documentation coordinator: Could you identify the two references so we can ask the authorized reviewer to clarify?

03 • Loan operations analyst: The checklist cites version three; the attachment cites version two. Their relationship isn't explained.

04 • Documentation coordinator: Then we need confirmation of the applicable agreement and evidence before relying on that completed status.

05 • Loan operations analyst: Can I assume the condition precedent is unchanged because the document titles are similar?

06 • Documentation coordinator: No. Similar titles don't establish equivalent requirements or satisfaction of a condition.

07 • Loan operations analyst: I'll request the current support and keep the loan-boarding question open for the authorized team.

08 • Documentation coordinator: Please also preserve the existing documents rather than change their version labels to make them match.

09 • Loan operations analyst: Understood. I'll record the discrepancy without deciding that an exception or funding approval has been granted.

10 • Documentation coordinator: Good. This clarification should establish the document basis, not substitute for the required lending review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Received collateral document or verified collateral record?

Separate fictional loan-boarding case: a collateral document is received, but its asset reference has not been checked against the loan record.

01 • Loan boarding coordinator: The collateral document arrived. Does received mean the collateral check is complete for boarding?

02 • Loan documentation lead: Not here. The asset reference still needs checking against the applicable loan record.

03 • Loan boarding coordinator: Could you clarify which reference the reviewer needs, rather than asking me to resend the entire file?

04 • Loan documentation lead: We need the asset identifier and its documented link to this loan, through the approved process.

05 • Loan boarding coordinator: The borrower name matches. Is that enough to assume the document covers the intended asset?

06 • Loan documentation lead: No. A matching name alone doesn't establish the collateral relationship or legal sufficiency.

07 • Loan boarding coordinator: I'll ask the document owner for clarification and describe the receipt separately from verification.

08 • Loan documentation lead: Good. Leave any condition-precedent or exception decision with the authorized reviewer.

09 • Loan boarding coordinator: I'll keep the check pending and avoid telling the relationship team that boarding is cleared.

10 • Loan documentation lead: That preserves the distinction between having a document and establishing what it supports in this case.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An exception request is not an approved exception

Separate fictional loan-operations case: a record says exception submitted, while a team note shortens it to exception approved; the decision is unavailable.

01 • Operations case officer: The team note says exception approved, but the source record only says exception submitted.

02 • Credit administration liaison: Could you clarify whether any decision record supports the stronger wording in that note?

03 • Operations case officer: None is attached. I can't establish approval from the information currently available to us.

04 • Credit administration liaison: Then request the authorized status and keep submitted distinct from accepted or approved.

05 • Operations case officer: Would it be reasonable to assume approval because the loan-boarding task is scheduled for tomorrow?

06 • Credit administration liaison: No. A schedule doesn't establish that a condition precedent or exception has been authorized.

07 • Operations case officer: I'll correct the coordination status to submitted and ask who can verify the decision.

08 • Credit administration liaison: Please preserve the source record and identify the exact exception reference for the reviewer.

09 • Operations case officer: I'll also tell the receiving team that this clarification does not itself authorize boarding or funding.

10 • Credit administration liaison: Good. We need a confirmed status, not a convenient inference from the planned timetable.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Loan Operations and Documentation

A loan operations checklist marks a condition complete, but the supporting document refers to a different version of the agreement.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Which agreement version governs this condition? Let's confirm the reference and required evidence before recording the item as complete in the operations checklist.

Scenario 2 | A condition uses an undefined completion label

A fictional loan checklist says documents okay but gives no reviewer or supporting reference. The loan file contains several versions. Ask what the label means and which evidence supports it; no funding decision is supplied.

Role A: Loan operations specialist: request the reviewer, applicable version, and evidence behind the label.

Role B: Documentation coordinator: acknowledge the missing basis and seek authorized clarification.

Possible opening: Could you clarify what documents okay means here and which reviewed version supports that status?

Success checks

- Identify the ambiguous status and missing evidence.
- Request the authorized review basis.
- Avoid inferring funding permission.

Add a complication: The coordinator is asked to interpret the label as permission to release funds.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Thirty reviewed does not mean thirty resolved

Fictional payment-operations update: 45 exceptions exist, 30 reviewed and 15 pending; resolution outcomes for the reviewed items are not supplied.

01 • Payments manager: We had forty-five exceptions, with thirty reviewed. Are all forty-five resolved now?

02 • Exception queue analyst: No. Fifteen are still awaiting review, and reviewed doesn't establish resolution for the other thirty.

03 • Payments manager: Then which progress figure can I accurately use in the operations meeting this morning?

04 • Exception queue analyst: Thirty reviews are complete and fifteen remain pending; resolution status needs its own verified count.

05 • Payments manager: Does the reviewed group include wire transfer and ACH items, or only one payment type?

06 • Exception queue analyst: That breakdown isn't supplied here. We should request it rather than infer the queue composition.

07 • Payments manager: I'll avoid saying sanctions screening is cleared just because an item received an initial review.

08 • Exception queue analyst: Correct. Each required status follows its authorized process and supporting evidence.

09 • Payments manager: Please obtain the resolution breakdown and identify which pending items need the next review contact.

10 • Exception queue analyst: I'll return verified counts and keep review completion separate from payment release or final resolution.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A batch is transmitted, acceptance is pending

Separate fictional payment case: an ACH file is transmitted; receiving-system acknowledgment is missing, and no settlement outcome is established.

01 • Payment operations coordinator: The ACH file was transmitted. Can we tell the business team the payments have settled?

02 • Processing analyst: No. Transmission is confirmed, but acknowledgment and the later payment status aren't established here.

03 • Payment operations coordinator: Then I should report the completed sending step and the missing receiving-system response separately.

04 • Processing analyst: Exactly. A file leaving our system doesn't prove acceptance or settlement at the destination.

05 • Payment operations coordinator: Should we send the file again immediately because we haven't received an acknowledgment yet?

06 • Processing analyst: Don't infer the appropriate action here. Follow the authorized exception process to avoid unsupported duplicate handling.

07 • Payment operations coordinator: I'll ask the responsible processing team for a status check and keep the uncertainty visible.

08 • Processing analyst: Good. Identify the file reference through the approved channel without sharing customer payment details broadly.

09 • Payment operations coordinator: The update will say transmitted, acknowledgment pending, and no confirmed settlement outcome yet.

10 • Processing analyst: That is useful progress reporting without turning a completed technical step into a financial guarantee.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A returned item still needs case follow-up

Separate fictional wire-transfer exception case: a return message is received, but the related account posting and customer communication remain unverified.

01 • Wire operations analyst: The return message arrived. Can I close the exception as completely resolved in today's summary?

02 • Payments team lead: Not yet. The related account posting and customer-communication status haven't been verified.

03 • Wire operations analyst: So return received is completed, while those follow-up checks remain open in the case.

04 • Payments team lead: Correct. We should avoid a single resolved label that hides unfinished work.

05 • Wire operations analyst: Can I tell the relationship manager the customer's funds are available again immediately?

06 • Payments team lead: That isn't established by the message alone. Obtain the authorized posting status before making that claim.

07 • Wire operations analyst: I'll ask the account-processing contact for the verified status and check who owns communication.

08 • Payments team lead: Good. Keep the return reason tied to its actual record, without inventing an explanation.

09 • Wire operations analyst: I'll report return received, posting verification pending, and communication ownership awaiting confirmation.

10 • Payments team lead: That describes the current exception queue accurately and points to the next work without premature closure.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Payment Operations and Exceptions

A payments queue has 45 exceptions, with 30 reviewed and 15 pending. A manager asks whether all items have been resolved.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: Thirty exceptions have been reviewed, but review does not necessarily mean resolution. Fifteen are still pending review. I'll report the disposition status separately so the update is accurate.

Scenario 2 | Queue counts use different timestamps

A fictional supervisor quotes 18 open payment exceptions from 09:00, while an analyst sees 12 at 10:00. No item-level change breakdown is available. Give a careful update and request the missing reconciliation of counts.

Role A: Payments analyst: identify the different timestamps and avoid inventing how six items changed status.

Role B: Operations supervisor: ask for the current count and the evidence needed to explain the change.

Possible opening: The counts come from different times; twelve are shown at ten, but we haven't verified the item-level changes.

Success checks

- State both timestamps and counts correctly.
- Avoid equating fewer exceptions with completed payments.
- Request the item-level status breakdown.

Add a complication: The supervisor wants to announce six completed payments from the count difference alone.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Correcting conflicting dispute explanations

Fictional fraud-operations coordination: a customer received conflicting process descriptions; the dispute outcome remains unknown. The dialogue is between a complaints liaison and case specialist.

01 • Customer complaints liaison: The customer received conflicting explanations of the dispute process and now expects a guaranteed refund.

02 • Fraud case specialist: I'm sorry our communication created that expectation. The case outcome has not been determined.

03 • Customer complaints liaison: One message mentioned provisional credit, while another called the case fully resolved.

04 • Fraud case specialist: Those aren't interchangeable statuses. We need the verified case record before explaining what applies here.

05 • Customer complaints liaison: Can I promise that opening a fraud claim automatically produces provisional credit for this account?

06 • Fraud case specialist: No. Don't invent an entitlement or timing; use the applicable process and authorized case information.

07 • Customer complaints liaison: I'll acknowledge the conflicting wording and explain that the review remains open.

08 • Fraud case specialist: Good. Also avoid describing a chargeback as a guaranteed final recovery for the customer.

09 • Customer complaints liaison: I'll ask the case owner for the confirmed next step and provide one consistent correction.

10 • Fraud case specialist: I'll support that status check and keep the communication correction separate from the unresolved dispute decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A temporary credit was described as final

Separate fictional dispute case: the verified record labels a credit temporary, but a service message calls it final; no final case decision exists.

01 • Service quality officer: The record labels this credit temporary, but our message told the customer it was final.

02 • Dispute operations lead: We need to correct that directly. The message overstated the status in the verified record.

03 • Service quality officer: How can I explain the correction without suggesting the customer misunderstood accurate information?

04 • Dispute operations lead: Say we used the wrong description and that the underlying dispute review remains open.

05 • Service quality officer: Should I predict whether the temporary credit will remain after the review to reassure them?

06 • Dispute operations lead: No. The final outcome isn't established, and we must follow the actual account's authorized communication process.

07 • Service quality officer: I'll explain the recorded status and ask the case team for the applicable next-step wording.

08 • Dispute operations lead: Good. Keep any provisional-credit terms tied to this case rather than announce a universal banking rule.

09 • Service quality officer: I'll record the correction and make sure future messages don't describe the fraud claim as settled.

10 • Dispute operations lead: That repairs the inaccurate statement without replacing it with another unsupported promise about the customer's money.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A callback was mistaken for case completion

Separate fictional fraud-claim case: an agent promised completion during a scheduled callback, but the case team agreed only to provide a progress update.

01 • Relationship service officer: The customer expects the dispute to finish during tomorrow's callback because of my earlier message.

02 • Fraud operations coordinator: The case team agreed a progress update, not a completion date. That expectation needs correcting.

03 • Relationship service officer: I'll apologize for describing the call as a decision meeting when that wasn't confirmed.

04 • Fraud operations coordinator: Please explain what the call can provide: verified progress and any confirmed next step.

05 • Relationship service officer: Could I say the chargeback should succeed soon, even though the review is still open?

06 • Fraud operations coordinator: No. That would add an unsupported prediction and may create another expectation about recovery.

07 • Relationship service officer: I'll keep timing and outcome unconfirmed rather than use reassuring language that changes the facts.

08 • Fraud operations coordinator: Good. Ask the case owner to verify the status before the callback is made.

09 • Relationship service officer: I'll update our contact note so another agent doesn't repeat my original promise.

10 • Fraud operations coordinator: That gives the customer a consistent correction while leaving the fraud claim decision with the authorized process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Fraud Operations and Customer Escalation

A customer reporting a disputed transaction receives conflicting explanations of the process. The case outcome has not been determined.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I'm sorry the explanations differed. Let me confirm the applicable process and your case status with the responsible team. I'll distinguish the next procedural step from any outcome that is still undecided.

Scenario 2 | The wrong transaction was discussed

A fictional customer disputed transaction T8, but an agent's reply referred to T3. No outcome is known for T8. Correct the reference in a call between service and fraud operations, using only the synthetic identifiers.

Role A: Service supervisor: acknowledge the incorrect reference and ask for T8's verified process status.

Role B: Fraud case coordinator: keep both cases distinct and avoid transferring any outcome from T3.

Possible opening: Our reply referred to T3, but the customer's dispute concerns T8; we need to correct that mismatch.

Success checks

- Correct the transaction reference explicitly.
- Keep T8's outcome unknown.
- Arrange a case-specific status check through the approved channel.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to reuse T3's response without checking T8.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Signed off does not mean every balance matched

Fictional operational-control discussion: a reconciliation is signed off while one unmatched balance remains under investigation; sign-off meaning has not been clarified.

01 • Operations reporting manager: The reconciliation is signed off, so can I say every balance has been matched?

02 • Control analyst: One unmatched balance remains under investigation. We need to clarify what the sign-off actually records.

03 • Operations reporting manager: Could you explain reconciliation in plain English for the colleague preparing the management slide?

04 • Control analyst: It's a comparison of records to identify differences; signing a review doesn't necessarily remove every difference.

05 • Operations reporting manager: Then completing a review and resolving an unmatched balance are distinct statuses in this case.

06 • Control analyst: Exactly. The current label shouldn't hide the open difference or its assigned follow-up.

07 • Operations reporting manager: Does that open item prove the control never operated or that someone committed fraud?

08 • Control analyst: Neither conclusion follows automatically. We need evidence about operation, findings, and the investigation.

09 • Operations reporting manager: I'll explain the open balance and request clarification of the sign-off and remediation status.

10 • Control analyst: Good. That communicates operational risk accurately without treating a signature as proof of a fully reconciled position.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A control description is not evidence of operation

Separate fictional risk review: a team has documented a daily control but has not supplied records showing it operated during the review period.

01 • Risk coordinator: The daily control is described in the manual. Does that prove it operated throughout the review period?

02 • Control assurance specialist: No. The description explains what should happen; operating evidence shows what actually happened.

03 • Risk coordinator: So a written control design and documented performance are different things we need to explain.

04 • Control assurance specialist: Yes. We should request relevant records rather than infer completed checks from the manual.

05 • Risk coordinator: Would missing evidence prove the team never performed any of those daily checks?

06 • Control assurance specialist: Not by itself. It establishes a gap in the evidence supplied, which needs further review.

07 • Risk coordinator: I'll describe the manual as available and the operating-evidence assessment as still open.

08 • Control assurance specialist: Good. Keep any finding or remediation plan tied to the actual review, not assumptions about staff.

09 • Risk coordinator: I'll ask the record owner for the specified period's support through the approved channel.

10 • Control assurance specialist: That distinction helps management understand both the documented process and what remains unverified about its operation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Fixing one item versus changing the process

Separate fictional operational-risk case: one erroneous internal entry has been corrected, but the process that produced it has not yet been assessed.

01 • Operations supervisor: We corrected the entry. Can we say the operational-risk issue has been permanently remediated?

02 • Risk and controls analyst: The individual error is corrected, but the contributing process hasn't been assessed yet.

03 • Operations supervisor: How would you explain the difference between that correction and broader remediation in ordinary language?

04 • Risk and controls analyst: One fixes this item; broader work addresses the process and checks whether the response is effective.

05 • Operations supervisor: Then the corrected entry is real progress without proving that similar errors cannot recur.

06 • Risk and controls analyst: Exactly. We should preserve that distinction and avoid a guarantee about all future activity.

07 • Operations supervisor: Should we immediately invent a new control based only on this one observation?

08 • Risk and controls analyst: The authorized review should assess causes and appropriate responses. This conversation doesn't establish a control design.

09 • Operations supervisor: I'll report the item correction and request the process-review status from its owner.

10 • Risk and controls analyst: Good. That separates a completed case action from the still-open assessment of systemic risk and remediation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Operational Risk and Controls

A reconciliation is signed off even though one unmatched balance remains under investigation.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: The reconciliation work has been performed, but the unmatched balance remains open. I'll show that exception and its review status instead of implying that every item has been resolved.

Scenario 2 | A completed checklist has an unresolved exception

A fictional control checklist is fully ticked, but an attached exception remains open. The meaning of the ticks has not been defined for the review. Explain why the attachment and checklist must be considered together.

Role A: Control analyst: distinguish a completed checklist from resolved exceptions.

Role B: Operations manager: ask what the ticks mean and who owns the open item.

Possible opening: The checklist is filled in, but the attached exception remains open and needs its own status explanation.

Success checks

- Keep the exception visible.
- Request clarification of checklist meaning.
- Avoid treating completed paperwork as proof of resolved risk.

Add a complication: The manager wants to remove the attachment from the briefing to avoid questions.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Request evidence for the stated examination period

Fictional examination preparation: a request asks for control-operation evidence over a stated period; only the policy document is ready.

01 • Examination coordinator: Could you provide evidence that the control operated during the period specified in the examiner's request?

02 • Operations control owner: The policy is ready. Do you need something beyond the description of how the control should work?

03 • Examination coordinator: Yes. The request concerns actual operation, so we need the relevant records for that stated period.

04 • Operations control owner: Can I send today's completed check as proof that all earlier checks were performed?

05 • Examination coordinator: Not as proof of the whole period. Match the evidence to the request and identify any gaps.

06 • Operations control owner: I'll check available records and confirm realistic retrieval timing through the approved review channel.

07 • Examination coordinator: Thank you. Please keep original dates and avoid recreating missing checks as if contemporaneous.

08 • Operations control owner: Does an evidence gap automatically become a final finding in the management response?

09 • Examination coordinator: That outcome belongs to the review. Our immediate task is an accurate, specific evidence response.

10 • Operations control owner: I'll provide the available support, missing portions, and retrieval status without overstating completeness.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The sample is ready but its approvals are missing

Separate fictional internal audit: transaction samples are collected, but linked review approvals requested by the auditor are not included.

01 • Audit liaison: Could you provide the linked review approvals for the collected sample, as requested in the audit evidence list?

02 • Operations records officer: We already supplied the sample transactions. Which part of the request remains unanswered?

03 • Audit liaison: The evidence of review approval for those same items, not a new unrelated sample.

04 • Operations records officer: I'll ask the record owner for the linked approvals and identify any that cannot be retrieved.

05 • Audit liaison: Please maintain the sample references so the reviewer can match each record to the original request.

06 • Operations records officer: Should I add an approval now if the reviewer remembers checking the item at the time?

07 • Audit liaison: Don't create retrospective evidence as an original record. Follow the authorized process for explaining any gap.

08 • Operations records officer: I'll distinguish available documentation from recollections and ask the audit lead how to present the latter.

09 • Audit liaison: Good. Confirm an achievable response point after checking availability rather than promising a complete bundle immediately.

10 • Operations records officer: I'll send the verified linked records through the approved channel with outstanding evidence clearly identified.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Ask what the management response still needs

Separate fictional examination follow-up: a draft management response says action taken but omits the action owner and supporting evidence; no finding closure is confirmed.

01 • Regulatory response coordinator: Could you identify the action owner and supporting evidence behind the draft phrase action taken?

02 • Operations remediation lead: I can provide the owner, but the evidence collection hasn't finished for this response.

03 • Regulatory response coordinator: Please give the confirmed ownership now and explain precisely which supporting records remain pending.

04 • Operations remediation lead: Would calling the finding closed make the response more decisive while we gather those records?

05 • Regulatory response coordinator: No. We don't have a confirmed closure, and the wording shouldn't exceed the verified status.

06 • Operations remediation lead: I'll request the missing evidence from its source and ask when it can be provided.

07 • Regulatory response coordinator: Good. The management response needs a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing for outstanding support.

08 • Operations remediation lead: Should I promise the examiner will accept the action once the bundle is complete?

09 • Regulatory response coordinator: No. Completeness of submission doesn't establish the examiner's assessment or acceptance.

10 • Operations remediation lead: I'll provide the verified action details and outstanding evidence status without predicting the review outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Audit and Regulatory Exams

An examination request asks for evidence of a control operating over a stated period. The team has only the policy document ready.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you identify the records that demonstrate the control's operation during the requested period? The policy describes the process, but we also need the relevant evidence of its use.

Scenario 2 | The evidence request names an unclear system

A fictional audit request asks for access-review records from the platform, but the team uses two platforms. The review period is specified; the platform is not. Clarify the system before collecting evidence.

Role A: Audit coordinator: request the exact platform and explain why it affects evidence selection.

Role B: Control owner: identify the ambiguity and agree to seek the requester's clarification.

Possible opening: Could you confirm which platform the request covers so we collect the correct records for the stated period?

Success checks

- Identify the missing system scope.
- Preserve the stated review period.
- Use authorized, relevant evidence sharing rather than indiscriminate disclosure.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests sending all records from both systems without checking relevance or access permissions.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The fee schedule does not settle this charge

Fictional complaint-coordination rehearsal: a current fee schedule is available, but its applicability to the customer's transaction has not been checked. The liaison practices a customer-facing correction with the reviewer.

01 • Customer service liaison: The customer asked why this fee was charged, and our reply only repeated the fee schedule.

02 • Complaints case reviewer: That didn't answer the question. Please rehearse an apology that preserves the unverified transaction status.

03 • Customer service liaison: Can I now say the fee was definitely correct because it appears in the current schedule?

04 • Complaints case reviewer: No. The schedule alone doesn't establish how it applies to this particular account event.

05 • Customer service liaison: I'm sorry our earlier reply only repeated the fee schedule. Its applicability to your transaction remains unchecked, so I cannot confirm the charge is correct.

06 • Complaints case reviewer: Good. Clear fee disclosure matters, but it isn't a substitute for investigating the specific complaint.

07 • Customer service liaison: Should I promise a refund to show fair treatment while the review is ongoing?

08 • Complaints case reviewer: Don't promise an unapproved outcome. Offer a verified status check through the applicable error-resolution process.

09 • Customer service liaison: I'll identify the follow-up owner and explain what remains open.

10 • Complaints case reviewer: That repairs the communication without deciding the fee's validity before the relevant facts are assessed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A current schedule was used for an older charge

Separate fictional complaint case: an agent explained a prior-period charge using the current fee schedule; the applicable earlier terms remain unverified.

01 • Service quality manager: Your reply used today's fee schedule, but the complaint concerns a charge from an earlier period.

02 • Customer support specialist: I should have checked the applicable period. I'll acknowledge that my explanation used an unverified basis.

03 • Service quality manager: What can you correct now without deciding whether the earlier charge was valid?

04 • Customer support specialist: I can say the current schedule doesn't establish the terms applicable to that earlier transaction.

05 • Service quality manager: Good. Then request the relevant historical documents and transaction details through the approved process.

06 • Customer support specialist: Should I tell the customer the older fee must have been lower than the current one?

07 • Service quality manager: No. We haven't reviewed it, so that would invent another factual claim about their charge.

08 • Customer support specialist: I'll keep the fee amount's basis unresolved and explain who is checking the applicable information.

09 • Service quality manager: Please also correct the contact record so other representatives don't repeat the same explanation.

10 • Customer support specialist: I'll do that and distinguish our communication error from the still-open assessment of the fee itself.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A fee-review request was described as a refund

Separate fictional case: a representative submitted a fee-review request but told the customer a refund was approved; no refund decision is recorded.

01 • Complaints coordinator: The customer expects a refund, but the record shows only a fee-review request submitted.

02 • Service team supervisor: We need to correct that promise. Submission isn't approval, and no refund decision is recorded.

03 • Complaints coordinator: I'll apologize that our message overstated progress and explain the verified review status.

04 • Service team supervisor: Please acknowledge the effect on the customer's expectations without suggesting they misread a clear message.

05 • Complaints coordinator: Could we authorize a goodwill payment ourselves just to make the original promise true?

06 • Service team supervisor: We can't invent authority here. Any proposed payment or exception follows the applicable approved process.

07 • Complaints coordinator: Then I'll ask the authorized reviewer for status and keep the refund outcome unconfirmed.

08 • Service team supervisor: Good. Fair treatment includes accurate communication, not different promises based on how strongly someone complains.

09 • Complaints coordinator: I'll update the contact note and identify who will deliver the next verified explanation.

10 • Service team supervisor: That repairs the inaccurate statement while preserving the customer's complaint and the actual fee-review process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Customer Complaints and Fair Treatment

A customer asks why a fee was charged. The representative has a current fee schedule but has not checked the transaction details.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I can explain the published fee schedule, and I'll ask the responsible team to review how it applies to this transaction. I do not want to give you an unverified explanation of the charge.

Scenario 2 | The complaint channel was stated incorrectly

A fictional customer was told a fee complaint could only be discussed in person. The supplied current service instruction also allows an authenticated phone appointment. No decision on the fee is available. Correct the channel information without generalizing to other banks.

Role A: Service supervisor: acknowledge the incorrect channel restriction and offer the verified phone option.

Role B: Customer advocate: explain the customer's difficulty attending and ask how an appointment can be arranged.

Possible opening: Our earlier message incorrectly limited the discussion to an in-person visit; this service also offers an authenticated phone appointment.

Success checks

- Correct the channel information using only the supplied instruction.
- Separate access to discussion from a complaint outcome.
- Agree an appointment-arrangement check without bypassing authentication.

Add a complication: The advocate asks you to promise a refund during that appointment.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

FinCEN: customer identification guidance

<https://www.fincen.gov/resources/statutes-regulations/guidance/interagency-interpretive-guidance-customer-identification>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Banking Operations English

Professional audience: bank operations staff, branch managers, loan operations teams, KYC/AML analysts, fraud operations staff, payment operations teams, compliance staff, and banking leaders

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Dialogue 01: Account-opening discrepancy

Original fictional setting: Bank staff reconcile identity information.

Professional roles: Account-opening analyst / Branch manager

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Account-opening analyst: The application address differs from the identity document. The required verification is incomplete.

Branch manager: Follow our customer-identification process and ask for the appropriate clarification or documentation.

Account-opening analyst: The customer wants the account opened immediately because they're traveling.

Branch manager: Explain the outstanding requirement clearly. Don't bypass it or promise approval before review.

Account-opening analyst: I'll record the discrepancy and the requested next step through the approved system.

Branch manager: I'll support the escalation if the circumstances require specialist review under the bank's process.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Banking Operations English

Professional audience: bank operations staff, branch managers, loan operations teams, KYC/AML analysts, fraud operations staff, payment operations teams, compliance staff, and banking leaders

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Dialogue 01: Account-opening discrepancy

Original fictional setting: Bank staff reconcile identity information.

Professional roles: Account-opening analyst / Branch manager

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Account-opening analyst: The application address differs from the identity document. The required verification is incomplete.

Branch manager: Follow our customer-identification process and ask for the appropriate clarification or documentation.

Account-opening analyst: The customer wants the account opened immediately because they're traveling.

Branch manager: Explain the outstanding requirement clearly. Don't bypass it or promise approval before review.

Account-opening analyst: I'll record the discrepancy and the requested next step through the approved system.

Branch manager: I'll support the escalation if the circumstances require specialist review under the bank's process.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level